

CHAPTER 1

Introduction to Search Engine Optimization (SEO)

Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter, you will be able to:

- Understand what SEO is.
 - Learn why SEO is important.
 - Understand how websites appear on Google.
 - Differentiate between organic and paid search.
 - Understand where SEO fits in digital marketing.
 - Learn important SEO terminologies.
 - Understand why businesses invest in SEO.
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Topic 1: What is the Internet?

Before understanding SEO, you must first understand the Internet because SEO exists only because websites exist on the Internet.

Definition

The **Internet** is a worldwide network of millions of computers and servers connected together. It allows people to communicate, share information, access websites, send emails, watch videos, and perform many other online activities.

Think of the Internet as a **huge city**.

- Every house in the city represents a website.
- Roads connecting the houses represent the Internet.
- People travelling on the roads represent users.
- Google acts like a guide that helps people find the correct house.

Without roads, people cannot reach houses.

Similarly,

Without the Internet, websites cannot be accessed.

Example

When you type

www.amazon.in

your computer connects through the Internet to Amazon's server and loads the website.

Real-Life Analogy

Imagine a library with millions of books.

The Internet is like the entire library.

Each book represents a website.

Google is the librarian who helps you find the correct book.

Key Points

- Global network
 - Connects billions of devices
 - Allows sharing of information
 - Hosts millions of websites
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Topic 2: What is a Website?

Now that we know what the Internet is, let's understand websites.

Definition

A **website** is a collection of related web pages stored on a web server and accessible through the Internet using a domain name.

Examples:

- amazon.in
- flipkart.com
- youtube.com
- wikipedia.org

Each of these is a website.

Components of a Website

A website usually contains:

- Home Page
 - About Us
 - Products
 - Services
 - Contact Page
 - Blog
 - Login Page
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Example

Amazon Website

Pages include:

Home



Electronics



Mobiles



Product Page



Payment Page

All these pages together form the Amazon website.

Why Websites are Important

Businesses use websites to

- Sell products
- Share information
- Provide services
- Build trust
- Generate leads
- Earn revenue

Without a website, SEO cannot be performed.

Topic 3: What is a Web Page?

Many beginners confuse a website with a web page.

Website vs Web Page

Website	Web Page
Collection of pages	Single page
Example: amazon.in	Example: amazon.in/mobile-phones
Contains many pages	Only one document
Like a book	Like one page of the book

Example

Website

www.flipkart.com

Web Pages

www.flipkart.com

www.flipkart.com/mobiles

www.flipkart.com/laptops

www.flipkart.com/fashion

www.flipkart.com/cart

Each URL represents a different web page.

Topic 4: What is a Search Engine?

Suppose there were no Google.

How would you find information among billions of websites?

Impossible.

This is where search engines help.

Definition

A **search engine** is a software system that searches billions of web pages and returns the most relevant results based on the user's search query.

Examples of search engines include:

- Google
- Bing
- Yahoo
- DuckDuckGo
- Baidu
- Yandex

Among these, Google is the most widely used search engine.

How a Search Engine Works (Basic Overview)

When you type:

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Google performs the following steps:

1. Receives your query.
 2. Searches its index (a huge database of web pages).
 3. Finds relevant pages.
 4. Ranks them based on hundreds of factors.
 5. Displays the best results on the Search Engine Results Page (SERP).
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Why Search Engines Are Important

Without search engines:

- You would need to know every website address.
- Finding information would be slow and difficult.
- Small businesses would struggle to be discovered.

Search engines make the internet usable by organizing and ranking information.

Summary of Topics Covered

- The **Internet** is the global network connecting devices.
 - A **website** is a collection of related web pages.
 - A **web page** is a single document within a website.
 - A **search engine** helps users find relevant web pages quickly.
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In the **next topic**, we'll cover "**How Search Engines Work**" in detail, including:

- Crawling
- Googlebot
- Indexing
- Ranking
- Search Engine Results Page (SERP)
- How Google decides which website appears first

This is one of the most important concepts in SEO and forms the foundation for everything that follows.